

Thursday, 24 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 22° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 21° 11°	MANCHESTER Overcast 21° 11°	GLASGOW Light rain 17° 8°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The head of the RAF has revealed the UK military is now jamming other nations' satellites to defend itself.

Air Chief Marshal Sir Richard Knighton said Britain faces "unprecedented threats" in space. A new unit has been created to protect UK satellites from adversaries.

DEFENCE · UK
- 2

The Home Secretary has criticised "unacceptable" migrant landings, after two unescorted boats arrived on UK shores.

These are the first uncontrolled landings recorded in the UK since 2025. The government is under pressure to address the issue.

MIGRATION · UK
- 3

Two pilots have ejected and parachuted out of an RAF plane before it crashed in North Wales.

North Wales Police confirmed the pilots of the RAF T2 Hawk aircraft are being treated for minor injuries. The cause of the crash is not yet known.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 4

Tributes have been paid to a "devoted" mum and her "precious" children who died in a house fire in Bootle.

Elisha Brabin, 36, and her three children, Leo, Ellis, and Prudence, died on Tuesday. An injured man found outside the house remains in hospital.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 5

The UK has been warned of ballooning debt costs and slower economic growth ahead of the Budget.

Experts say higher energy prices, due to the conflict in the Middle East and climate change, could significantly impact growth. This comes as the government prepares its financial plans.

ECONOMY · UK

What's coming up

1 **Great news for Eurovision fans! The Netherlands has confirmed it will return to the contest next year after boycotting in 2026.**

The country chose not to participate in this year's event but will be back for the 2027 contest in Bulgaria. It's always good to have more nations taking part.

ON AIR – Are you glad to see the Netherlands back in Eurovision? Who are you hoping will represent the UK next year?

EUROVISION · COMING UP

2 **Oasis fans rejoice! The band has announced additional shows in Knebworth, Rome, and Munich due to "phenomenal demand."**

After their highly anticipated reunion, the Gallagher brothers are clearly still a huge draw. More chances for fans to catch them live.

ON AIR – Are you hoping to get tickets for the new Oasis dates? What's your favourite Oasis song?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3 **The Prince and Princess of Wales shared a laugh with Hollywood star Tom Cruise at the premiere of his new film, 'Digger'.**

William and Catherine renewed their friendship with Cruise, who is known for his action-packed movies. It sounds like a fun evening out.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Tom Cruise movie? Would you go and see 'Digger'?

FILM · THIS WEEK

4 **The shortlist for this year's prestigious Booker Prize has been revealed, with some big names in the running.**

Past winners Marlon James and Douglas Stuart are among the nominees, after what judges described as a selection "tussle." The winner will be announced soon.

ON AIR – Have you read any of the shortlisted books? Who do you think should win the Booker Prize this year?

BOOKS · COMING UP

5 **Ella Langley's country smash 'Choosin' Texas' has made US chart history, becoming the longest-running number one ever!**

The song has now spent an incredible 23 weeks at the top, breaking a record previously held by Mariah Carey. A massive achievement for the country star.

ON AIR – Have you heard 'Choosin' Texas'? What's your favourite country song right now?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

- 1** **Championship leader Kimi Antonelli has spoken about how a 2024 crash transformed him as an F1 driver.**
He told BBC Sport he's "still finding his way" but the incident "stayed in my head for a very long time." It sounds like it was a real turning point.

ON AIR – What do you think makes a great F1 driver? Do you think Antonelli can go all the way and win the championship?

F1 · THIS WEEK

- 2** **Manchester United's debt remains over £1 billion, despite Sir Jim Ratcliffe's cost-cutting measures.**
The club also confirmed it has spent £63.5 million buying land for their new stadium. It's a huge sum, even for a club of United's size.

ON AIR – What do you make of Manchester United's debt? Do you think the new stadium plans are a good investment?

FOOTBALL · UK

- 3** **England's Will Jacks went from emergency surgery to match-winner in an incredible turnaround this week.**
His career-best 50-over figures came shortly after he was rushed to hospital for emergency surgery. What a story of resilience!

ON AIR – What's the most incredible sporting comeback you've ever seen? How important is mental strength in sport?

CRICKET · UK

- 4** **British riders have a strong chance of glory at cycling's Road World Championships this weekend.**
With Tadej Pogacar absent, young British talent is blossoming at elite level. Could we see a new champion crowned?

ON AIR – Are you following the Road World Championships? Who are you backing for the win?

CYCLING · THIS WEEK

- 5** **England eased to a big victory over Sri Lanka in the first One Day International, with Will Jacks starring with bat and ball.**

England maintained their excellent one-day form, securing an 89-run win at Chester-le-Street. Jacks' performance was truly match-winning.

ON AIR – Did you watch the match? What did you make of Will Jacks' performance?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees more people embracing the joy of 'slow gardening'.**
Instead of quick fixes, gardeners are taking their time, appreciating each stage of growth, and finding peace in the unhurried process.
- 2 Research suggests that 'reading aloud' to yourself can boost memory retention.**
The act of both seeing and hearing the words helps to solidify information in the brain, making it a great study technique.
- 3 The simple pleasure of 'writing and sending physical letters' is making a charming comeback.**
Many are rediscovering the warmth and personal touch of a handwritten note in an increasingly digital world.
- 4 Scientists have found that listening to the sound of 'rain on a tin roof' can be surprisingly calming.**
The rhythmic, consistent sound is thought to reduce stress and aid relaxation, perhaps by mimicking white noise.
- 5 More households are setting up 'dedicated reading nooks' as a sanctuary for quiet time.**
These cosy corners, often filled with cushions and blankets, offer a perfect escape for book lovers.
- 6 The delightful practice of 'swapping homemade recipes' is fostering community spirit.**
Friends and neighbours are sharing their culinary secrets, leading to delicious discoveries and closer bonds.
- 7 A study highlights the mental benefits of 'watching clouds pass by'.**
This simple act of mindful observation can help to clear the mind, reduce anxiety, and encourage creativity.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of tea will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE DRY LEAVES THROUGH THE PACKET BEFORE BUYING IT!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new dessert, especially if it's a special treat. What is it?

ANSWER: TAKING A PHOTO OF IT FROM AT LEAST THREE DIFFERENT ANGLES!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of bird song' just instantly brings a sense of peace or reminds you of a specific place?

Which bird song has that special effect on you, and what memories does it bring to mind?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, despite its simplicity, you genuinely couldn't imagine your kitchen without because it's just so useful or brings you joy, don't we?

What's that one indispensable, perhaps quirky, item in your kitchen that you absolutely adore?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of pugs is collectively known as a 'grumble'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, which are covered in tiny taste receptors.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£111 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£111 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's largest known snowflake was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, reported in Montana in 1887.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The shortest war in history lasted only 38 to 45 minutes, between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896.
- Bees can fly higher than Mount Everest; they have been observed at altitudes of up to 29,500 feet.
- The sound of a human yawn is contagious, even for blind people who hear the sound.
- The 'richest' bird's nest ever found contained over 300 pieces of gold jewellery.
- An octopus has three hearts; two pump blood through the gills and one circulates blood to the rest of the body.
- There are more fake flamingos in the world than real ones.

On this day

Day 267 of the year, 98 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Peru); Christian feast day: Anathalon (in Brescia); Christian feast day: Antonio Gonzalez; Christian feast day: Blessed Anton Martin Slomšek. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1941 — Linda McCartney, American singer, photographer, and activist (died 1998)
- 1988 — Kyle Sullivan, American actor
- 1931 — Anthony Newley, English singer and actor (died 1999)
- 1946 — Jerry Donahue, American guitarist and producer
- 1914 — Esther Eng, Chinese-American film director (died 1970)
- 1944 — Victoria Vetri, Playboy's 1967 Miss September and 1968 Playmate of the Year.
- 1950 — Harriet Walter, English actress
- 1970 — Marc Guggenheim, American screenwriter, television producer, comic book writer, and novelist

THE DAY TODAY

- 2008 — Thabo Mbeki resigns as president of South Africa.
- 2023 — NASA's OSIRIS-REx capsule containing samples from the asteroid 101955 Bennu successfully lands back on Earth.
- 2015 — At least 1,100 people are killed and another 934 wounded after a stampede during the Hajj in Saudi Arabia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1960 — USS Enterprise, the world's first nuclear-powered aircraft carrier, is launched.
- 2023 — NASA's OSIRIS-REx capsule containing samples from the asteroid 101955 Bennu successfully lands back on Earth.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1932 — Mahatma Gandhi and B. R. Ambedkar agree to the Poona Pact, which reserved seats in the Indian provincial legislatures for the "Depressed Classes" (Untouchables).
- 1975 — Southwest Face expedition members become the first persons to reach the summit of Mount Everest by any of its faces, instead of using a ridge route.

- 1935 — Earl and Weldon Bascom produce the first rodeo ever held outdoors under electric lights.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 268 of the year, 97 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day or Revolution Day (Mozambique); Bangladeshi Immigration Day (United States); Christian feast day: Abadir and Irajā and Companions (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Aunarius (Aunacharius). Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1974 — Paul Hurst, English footballer and manager
- 1949 — Anson Williams, American actor, singer, and director
- 1983 — Donald Glover (also known as Childish Gambino), American actor, rapper, producer, and screenwriter
- 1968 — Will Smith, American actor, producer, and rapper
- 2009 — Leah Jeffries, American actress
- 1962 — Aida Turturro, American actress
- 1952 — Christopher Reeve, American actor, producer, and activist (died 2004)
- 1961 — Heather Locklear, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1963 — Lord Denning releases the UK government's official report on the Profumo affair.
- 1964 — The Mozambican War of Independence against Portugal begins.
- 1937 — Second Sino-Japanese War: The Chinese Eighth Route Army gains a minor, but morale-boosting victory in the Battle of Pingxingguan.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1959 — S. W. R. D. Bandaranaike, Prime Minister of Ceylon, is mortally shot by a Buddhist monk, Talduwe Somarama, and dies the next day.
- 1998 — PaukAir Flight 4101, a British Aerospace 146, crashes near Melilla Airport in Melilla, Spain, killing 38 people.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar